

as the File menu, and many commands in the menus are the same, such as New in the File menu. A good way to start learning how to use an application is to try each menu command to see what it does.

- Status menu icons, such as the volume icon, appear at the right of the menu bar. On clicking a status menu icon, you'll see commands or additional information related to the icon. Status menu icons can be added or removed in System Preferences panes and some applications, such as iChat.
- At the far right of the menu bar is the Spotlight menu. Click the Spotlight menu icon and type a word or two for something you want to find.

6.1.2 The Dock



Apple's Dock gives you quick access to commonly used applications

The Dock usually appears at the bottom of the screen with icons for applications used frequently. To open an application, just click its icon in the Dock.

- The Finder is the first icon at the left of the Dock. Click it to start Finder.
- Application icons appear between the Finder icon and the bar. A black triangle shows an application is open. Some application icons in the Dock show status information. For example, the Mail icon shows the number of unread messages it has.
- The bar separates applications from other items in the Dock. It can be dragged to change the size of the Dock.
- Icons for folders and documents appear to the right of the bar. If you add a folder to the Dock, you can press it to see a list of items in the folder, then choose the one you want to open.
- The Trash is used to delete files. Just drag files to the Trash then choose Empty Trash from the Finder menu. To see what's in the Trash, click its icon.
- To add an item to the Dock, drag it to the Dock. You can add applications, files, folders, servers, Web sites, and more.
- The Dock can be customised in many ways, including its size and position. Open System Preferences, then click Dock to customize the Dock.